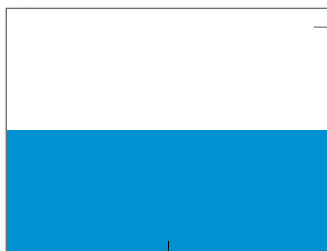


# San Marino

**Ratio:** 4:5 **Adopted:** April 6, 1862 **Usage:** National and Civil

The colors are taken from the traditional arms, which is placed at the center of the flag for official purposes only



*White represents the snow on Mt. Titano and the clouds above it*

*Blue recalls the sky*

Europe



Founded in the 4th century, the Republic of **San Marino** is one of the smallest and oldest in the world. It lies on the slopes of Mt. Titano in Italy.

The flag of San Marino dates back to 1797 and was recognized by Napoleon as that of an independent state in 1799. The colors were taken from the coat of arms and were introduced in the 18th century. Blue is said to represent the sky over San Marino and white the clouds and snow on Mt. Titano.

The traditional coat of arms is placed in the center of the flag for official purposes only. It depicts three white towers crowned with ostrich plumes, representing three citadels resting on the peak of Mt. Titano, which was once vaned with ostrich feathers. They symbolize the state's ability to defend itself.

## ARMS OF SAN MARINO

*A wreath of laurel*

*The motto "Libertas," meaning "Liberty," also dates back to the 4th century, when the state was established as a refuge for those fleeing religious persecution*



*A wreath of oak*

*The towers represent the three citadels, Guaita, Cesta, and Montale, situated on Mt. Titano*